

Silky anteater

Cyclopes didactylus

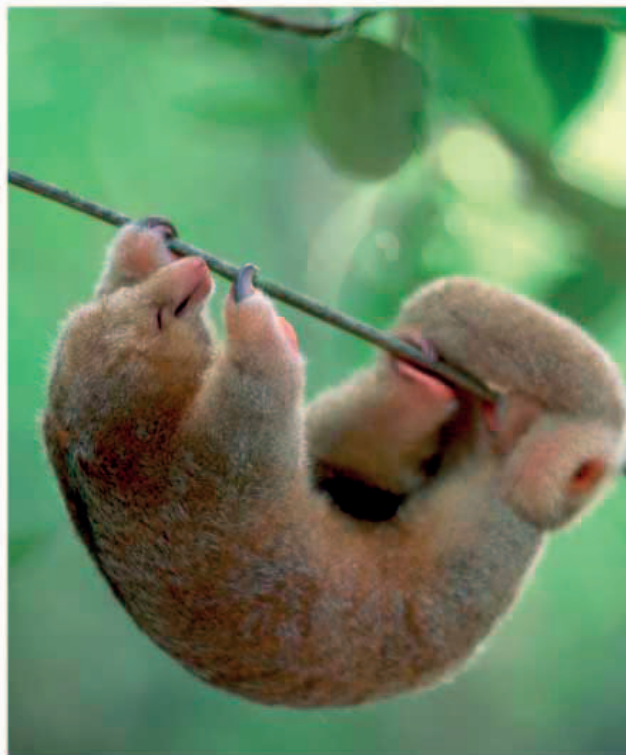
The world's smallest anteater is not much longer than a human hand. Seldom seen, silky anteaters live on trees, feed from sunset to sunrise on as many as 5,000 ants each night, and rest through the day. While the nocturnal habit protects them from humans, these anteaters are preyed upon by harpy eagles, hawks, and spectacled owls.

Silken disguise

Silky anteaters live in silk floss trees, which provide the perfect camouflage for the anteater with its long, fine, smoky-gray fur. Each front foot of the anteater has two enlarged claws, which are perfect for climbing and digging into tree-ant nests but must be turned inward for it to move on the ground. Although the silky anteater rarely comes to the ground, it walks well on flat surfaces and has been seen crossing roads. It also has a prehensile tail and specially adapted hindfeet that wrap firmly around branches, allowing it to move through the canopy.

After mating, a single baby anteater is born in a leaf-lined nest usually situated in a tree hollow. Both parents raise the baby, feeding it regurgitated ants. Males carry the babies on their backs.

fine, dense fur



- ↔ 7–9 in (16–21 cm)
- ⚖ 6–13 oz (175–357 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐜 Ants, termites, ladybugs
- 🏠



Central
America to N.
South America

◀ FAST ASLEEP

The silky anteater spends its daylight hours sleeping high in the safety of trees, often simply hanging from its hooklike front claws, prehensile tail, and wraparound hindfeet.

South American coati

Nasua nasua

Coatis move easily between different environments. Although terrestrial, coatis mate, give birth, and sleep in trees. Good climbers with powerful forelegs, they rotate their ankle joints to descend headfirst from trees, but easily jump from branch to branch, using their long tails for balance. They are also good swimmers. Strong claws and a flexible nose make them expert foragers.

Female coatis form bands of up to 65 animals. During the mating season, each band is joined by a male, which mates with all receptive females, then departs. Litters of one to seven young are born in spring and early summer. The females rejoin their band once the youngsters can walk and climb.

▽ HEALTHY APPETITE

Active and inquisitive members of the raccoon family, coatis feed on everything from small mammals, birds, and insects to fruit and leaves.



banded tail

- ↔ 17–23 in (43–58 cm)
- ⚖ 5–16 lb (2–7.2 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐜 Fungi, berries, insects, mice
- 🏠



W. South
America